

Ending Well

How a thing ends decides what you carry into what comes next. Twelve weeks of Breaking Free are ending. Before you close it, say what is different, what it cost, what you saw along the way, what God did, and what you are taking with you — in your own words, one line at a time. Each line starts for you; you finish it.

This sheet carries the same questions as the page, for working away from a screen. When you are ready, type your lines into Ending Well in Week 12 so it is saved to your page.

Part 1 of 8 — The Doorway

The course's last charge was "stay with the men you walked with." This is where you say it to them.

Twelve weeks are done. Start with the men. One word for what you feel toward them now — the row has some — then why, in a few words.

Finish the line. For example: To the men I walked with, I am hopeful and restless, wanting what the future offers, sometimes expecting that today.

Words to choose from: thankful · grateful · sad · still struggling with · hopeful

To the men I walked with, I am ...

Name the gold. Not what they did for you — who they showed themselves to be. One thing, said plainly.

Finish the line. For example: What I saw in you was men who told the truth before it was safe to.

Words to choose from: courage · honesty · steadiness · patience · mercy · humor · faith · the way you listened

What I saw in you was ...

Part 2 of 8 — Where I started

Start where you started. Three lines, and a picture a man could see.

Go back to the first week. Where were you — the place, the time of day, what was going on at home? A picture, not a label.

Finish the line. For example: When I started, I was sitting in the truck in the driveway, not ready to go in the house.

When I started, I was ...

Now the sentence you were living on then — the one you said to yourself to get through the day. “I’ve got it handled.” “Nobody needs to know.” Short.

Finish the line. For example: What I told myself was that I had it handled.

What I told myself was ...

And the part of it no one could see from outside.

Finish the line. For example: What nobody knew was that this has been a lifetime of hiding.

What nobody knew was ...

Part 3 of 8 — What changed

Time didn’t change you. The work you did in this room did. Say what is different, in three places: body, soul, spirit.

Week 1 called it your Sphere of Influence: “any sound, sight, smell, or touch, you control.” And: “The enemy has had free rein inside your SOI, and he’s been bringing his trash in with him.” What was coming in?

Finish the line. For example: What came in through my eyes and ears was the sights and sounds of desire and satisfaction, something so absent from my real life.

What came in through my eyes and ears was ...

The same eyes and ears. Now you are the gatekeeper for what comes in. What do you let in — a first thing in the morning, a habit that has held, a practice you took up? Pick from the row, or write your own.

Finish the line. For example: What I take in now is the view of the room from my knees, the walk with prayer as my partner, the study times where I seek relationship.

Words to choose from: meditation · prayer · fasting · study · simplicity · solitude · submission · service · confession · worship · guidance · celebration *From Richard Foster’s Celebration of Discipline. Walk With Me teaches all twelve.*

What I take in now is ...

Pick where it is happening, then say what is new there.

Finish the line. For example: What is being renewed in me is the way I engage the community, my family and friends; I lead with grace instead of contempt, and shame has nowhere to hide.

Words to choose from: how I name what I feel · how I see my father · how I see my wife · how I see my kids · how I see other men · how I see myself · what I do with silence · what I call a win · what I do first in the morning

What is being renewed in me is ...

Spirit is where you and God meet. Of faith, hope and love, which one grew — and what does it look like in an ordinary week?

Finish the line. For example: Between me and God, what is growing is desire to know Him more and faith in the path to do that.

Words to choose from: faith · hope · love

Between me and God, what is growing is ...

Part 4 of 8 — Between the lines

Two of your lines. What happened between them?

Then: *When I started, I was ...* Now: *What I take in now is ...*

A day, a place, something said or done. One or two sentences; the row has some ways to start.

In your words. For example: What happened next was a week I almost skipped, and didn't.

Words to choose from: What happened next was · While that was going on, · Around the same time, · It took weeks, but

Part 5 of 8 — What God did

I will turn their mourning into joy; I will comfort them, and give them gladness for sorrow. — Jeremiah 31:13

If it is still quiet and the struggle is still here, say that. It is not failure. This takes years, not weeks, and God's answer may be as small as a room with men in it.

Not the story itself — the night you told it. What did the men do with it? In a room like that, shame has no place to hide.

Finish the line. For example: You saw me, and I'm not sure which night or exactly what I said. What I remember is learning to trust as the nights became the source of community I had longed for.

You saw me ...

Before you said it out loud — what did you brace for? Being judged, being handled, the room going quiet.

Finish the line. For example: What I expected was that no one would care, understand or accept me. I was afraid to be known.

What I expected was ...

What they did. Say it plainly; it is the part a man needs to hear.

Finish the line. For example: What happened instead was a man said "me too."

What happened instead was ...

What did you ask God for at the start? Say it the way you said it then. Not every ask is answered yet.

Finish the line. For example: I asked him for death or life. Either way I was ready to surrender everything I had become.

I asked him for ...

You asked him for: *I asked him for ...* (your line above)

Say what he did, not what you did. For some men it is this: a room with men in it, and what got named there. If nothing has moved yet, say that — it is true, and it belongs here.

Finish the line. For example: What God did was set the path ahead with men that had already walked it, a freedom trail merchandised with the right mix of beautiful views, difficult terrain and resting spots.

What God did was ...

Part 6 of 8 — Between the lines

Two more pairs of your lines. What happened between each?

Hidden: *What nobody knew was ...* Seen: *You saw me ...*

The thing nobody knew, and the night the men saw you. What happened in between — a day, a place, something said or done?

In your words. For example: It took weeks, but one night I said it out loud before I could talk myself out of it.

Words to choose from: What happened next was · While that was going on, · Around the same time, · It took weeks, but

Asked: *I asked him for ...* Answered: *What God did was ...*

What you asked him for, and what he did. How long did it take, and what did the waiting look like?

In your words. For example: While that was going on, I kept asking, and for a month nothing changed except that I kept showing up.

Words to choose from: What happened next was · While that was going on, · Around the same time, · It took weeks, but

Part 7 of 8 — What I take with me

Jesus turned and saw them following and said to them, “What are you seeking?” — John 1:38

His first question to the men who followed him. Answer it for a year from now.

A year down the trail — what do you want to be true? Say it as a man who means to get there.

Finish the line. For example: My hope for the future is to know God more intimately, grow in faith, offer my testimony in community.

My hope for the future is ...

An ending is a loss, even a good one. Say what aches. It is holy ground, not weakness.

Finish the line. For example: What I will miss is knowing that once a week someone would ask.

What I will miss is ...

The twelve weeks are done. What do you need from these men now?

Finish the line. For example: What I ask of you is to remember me, consider me, reach out to me when you do and expect of me the same.

What I ask of you is ...

Yes or no — say it plainly and own it. Both are honorable. A goodbye said well is an ending done right.

Finish the line. For example: Going forward, with this group, I will say thank you for walking this path with me and goodbye for now. I hope we can join one another on another path in the future.

Words to choose from: stay · say goodbye

Going forward, with this group, I will ...

Not the whole life. One small thing, repeated, that moves you one degree — something you could start tomorrow.

Finish the line. For example: The one small thing I will try this month is joining a circle of men that chose to grow with the community of believers.

The one small thing I will try this month is ...

How will you know? Something you could see or count, four weeks from now.

Finish the line. For example: I'll know it has held when it is still happening four weeks from now.

I'll know it has held when ...

Name the sign before it comes — what you will be doing, and what you will be feeling. Pick from the rows, or write your own.

Finish the line. For example: I'll know I've drifted when my phone goes quiet and I tell myself I'm fine.

Words to choose from: a missed week · a quiet phone · a bad night · "I'm fine" · the old screen · a long silence

I'll know I've drifted when ...

Not a name — the words. What does it say?

Finish the line. For example: The voice that calls me back says what it said the first time: surrender.

Words to choose from: “You’re not alone in this.” · “Come back.” · “Do the next right thing.” · “They heard the worst and stayed.”

The voice that calls me back says ...

Week 12: “The days are not the achievement. Whatever you did that made the days is the achievement. Find it, name it out loud in the room, and do it again.” Pick one, or write your own.

Finish the line. For example: I will answer it by reading my journal and reaching out for coffee.

Words to choose from: a call · a text · coffee · a meeting · reading this again

I will answer it by ...

Part 8 of 8 — Set a stone

When your children ask in time to come, ‘What do those stones mean to you?’ then you shall tell them... So these stones shall be to the people of Israel a memorial forever. — Joshua 4:6–7

Israel set twelve stones at the Jordan so that when their children asked “What do those stones mean to you?” there would be an answer. A stone is set to be found again — by you, and by whoever asks. Choose yours: one of your own lines above, or the words you walk by.

Or your own words.

Your own words. For example: I asked him for death or life. Either way I was ready to surrender everything I had become.

Naming well is a skill. Name the one this is for, and you will name other things well too.

Finish the line. For example: This stone is for those who chose the same path.

Words to choose from: my son · my daughter · my wife · a friend · a man I walk with · my group · the man I was · myself, a year from now · someone who will ask one day

This stone is for ...

On the page you can tap one of your own lines from What God did instead. Three months after you set it, we will ask you what it means to you.

Written at the end of Breaking Free. · ancientpathcoaching.com